

# YAOTIAN (JUSTIN) ZHANG

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## EDUCATION

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| <b>University of Nebraska–Lincoln</b><br><i>Ph.D. in Economics</i>                                                                                                                                                      | Lincoln, NE, USA<br>2026–present (expected 2031) |
| <b>Central European University</b><br><i>M.A. in Economics, Data, and Policy (Research Track)</i><br>Thesis: “Green Borders: Cross-Border Enforcement Spillovers from Cannabis Legalization.” Advisor: Sergey Lychagin. | Vienna, Austria<br>2024–2026                     |
| <b>Stockholm School of Economics</b><br><i>Erasmus+ Exchange Semester</i>                                                                                                                                               | Stockholm, Sweden<br>Fall 2025                   |
| <b>University of Macau</b><br><i>B.A. in Economics</i>                                                                                                                                                                  | Macau, China<br>2020–2024                        |

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Labor Economics, Urban Economics, Public Economics

## WORKING PAPERS

### “Green Borders: Cross-Border Enforcement Spillovers from Cannabis Legalization”

Illinois opened an adult-use cannabis market in 2020 while neighboring Iowa retained prohibition. Using incident-based crime records for all Iowa counties, I find that counties connected to Illinois by a highway bridge recorded more drug and property offenses after the market opened, with effects that attenuate with distance from the Illinois population. The results suggest that revenue accounting confined within state lines understates the cost of legalization.

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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| <b>Bureau of Business Research, University of Nebraska–Lincoln</b><br><i>Graduate Research Assistant to Eric Thompson</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Study skills gaps and educational mismatch in Nebraska labor markets using ACS microdata.</li></ul> | 2026–present |
| <b>Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Macau</b><br><i>Research Assistant</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Collected, scraped, and cleaned data on online political content, and replicated machine learning workflows in R.</li></ul>               | 2023–2024    |

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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| <b>Teaching Assistant</b> , Graduate Workshops on Causal Inference and Research Methods<br><i>Hong Kong Metropolitan University</i> | Summer 2025 |
| <b>Teaching Assistant</b> , Introductory R Programming<br><i>Lui Che Woo College, University of Macau</i>                           | Spring 2024 |

## FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Carpenter Fellowship, <i>College of Business, University of Nebraska–Lincoln</i>     | 2026       |
| Master’s Distinction Scholarship, <i>Central European University</i>                 | 2024–2026  |
| Dean’s Honour List (top 10%), <i>Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Macau</i> | 2023, 2024 |

## SKILLS

**Programming:** R, Stata, Python, LaTeX, ArcGIS  
**Languages:** Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), German (basic), Swedish (basic)